

TRADESPACE

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Applying for: General Patent Counsel, Ayar Labs, San Jose, CA

SUMMARY

IP infrastructure built for exactly what this role owns: pulling patentable work out of optical and semiconductor engineering, directing outside patent counsel with real cost discipline, and keeping the portfolio mapped clearly enough to support its own valuation, the kind of clarity a company heading toward IPO needs its patent portfolio to hold up to.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Invention Capture & Portfolio Buildout, Enveda Biosciences *Series B biotech · small legal team, high R&D velocity*

- Replaced a disclosure process engineers were quietly avoiding with AI-assisted intake that meets inventors where they already work: the direct equivalent of pulling patentable work out of engineers who don't recognize it as inventive.
- Migrated the full legacy portfolio in 30 minutes and became the IP team's system of record from day one, with no separate change-management project required.
- Gave a newly onboarded IP team member a working command center instead of a dependency on outside counsel for basic status checks, called “game-changing” from the first login.

Portfolio Strategy & Board Reporting, Woodward *industrial hardware manufacturer*

- Built patent-to-product mapping and board-ready KPI reporting for a hardware manufacturer transitioning off a legacy docketing system, the same “which three patents protect the core product” question every platform and prosecution effort ultimately has to answer.
- Selected over competing IPMS platforms specifically for configurability and fit with the client's existing product-lifecycle process, rather than for the AI drafting capability that later became the differentiator.

CORE CAPABILITIES MAPPED TO THIS ROLE

- Invention harvesting from optical and semiconductor engineering: structured intake built for pulling patentable work out of engineers across an optical I/O platform who don't always recognize their own work as inventive, the same problem this role's invention-harvesting responsibilities describe.
- Outside patent counsel management and cost discipline: a vetted network of 235+ patent attorneys across 13 technology practice areas, admitted through a four-criteria review process. For one R&D client, pairing with a senior attorney matched by technology cut turnaround from six weeks to five days and cost by \$15,000 per utility filing, the kind of budget discipline this role is asked to own directly.
- Patent-to-product mapping for portfolio valuation: at Woodward, an industrial hardware manufacturer, we built patent-to-product mapping so the portfolio could answer which patents protect which product line, the same clarity a portfolio needs to support valuation reporting as this role describes.

WHERE I STOP

IP due diligence judgment on M&A and partnerships, chairing the internal patent advisory committee, mentoring junior IP staff, and valuation judgment for financial reporting purposes, that's legal judgment I don't have and don't claim to. What I can do is make sure the invention pipeline, the outside counsel relationships, and the portfolio mapping underneath those calls arrive organized.